Apex Systems

Enterprise engineering for mission-critical service platforms

Response to MRG-RFP-2026-014: Customer Service Platform Modernisation
Prepared for Meridian Retail Group (fictional)

1. Executive Summary and Understanding of the Requirement

Apex Systems is pleased to respond to RFP MRG-RFP-2026-014. We understand that Meridian Retail Group needs to replace three legacy contact-centre tools with a single omnichannel customer service platform that supports 1,200 agents today and 3,000 agents within three years, integrates with the existing Salesforce CRM, SAP S/4HANA order management and the Genesys telephony estate, and meets the security expectations of a listed retailer.

Our proposal prioritises architectural robustness and security. It is not the lowest-cost option; it is designed to remain stable at peak trading volumes such as festive-season sales.

2. Proposed Solution and Technical Approach

The platform uses a cloud-native microservices architecture deployed on Kubernetes across two availability zones with active-active failover. Each service (case management, routing, knowledge, analytics) scales horizontally through autoscaling policies tied to queue depth.

Integration is delivered through a central API gateway with versioned REST APIs and an event bus (Apache Kafka). We provide pre-built connectors for Salesforce CRM, SAP S/4HANA and Genesys Cloud, with a documented integration specification for each interface, including field mappings, error handling and retry behaviour.

Scalability evidence: in a load test for a comparable retailer the platform sustained 5,000 concurrent agents and 40,000 interactions per hour with p95 API latency under 300 ms. We commit to a 99.95% availability SLA.

3. Implementation Approach, Timeline, Team and Milestones

Delivery follows a 24-week plan in four phases: Discovery and Design (weeks 1-5), Build and Integration (weeks 6-15), Testing and UAT (weeks 16-20) and Rollout (weeks 21-24).

Milestones: M1 solution design sign-off (week 5), M2 integrations complete (week 15), M3 UAT sign-off (week 20), M4 go-live (week 24).

Team structure: one delivery manager, one solution architect, six engineers, two QA engineers and one security engineer. A risk register will be maintained and reviewed fortnightly with Meridian.

4. Commercial Proposal

Item	Price (USD)
Platform licences (3 years, 1,200 agents)	$720,000
Implementation services (fixed price)	$360,000
Integration connectors (Salesforce, SAP, Genesys)	$110,000
Training and change management	$50,000
Total contract value (3 years)	**$1,240,000**

Pricing assumptions

Prices exclude applicable taxes. Implementation is fixed price; licences are invoiced annually in advance. Additional agents beyond 1,200 are priced at $180 per agent per year. Payment milestones are aligned to M1-M4. Total cost of ownership over three years is shown above; there are no additional mandatory fees.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex Systems holds ISO/IEC 27001:2022 certification and a SOC 2 Type II report (audit period ending June 2026), both available under NDA.

Data is encrypted at rest using AES-256 and in transit using TLS 1.3. Encryption keys are managed in a customer-dedicated KMS with key rotation every 90 days.

Access control uses SSO via SAML 2.0, role-based access control (RBAC) and multi-factor authentication for all administrative users. Immutable audit logs are retained for 13 months and can be exported to Meridian's SIEM.

We comply with GDPR and India's Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act 2023, support data residency in India, and commission an independent penetration test annually. A documented incident response plan commits to notifying Meridian within 24 hours of a confirmed incident.

6. Support Model, Relevant Experience and References

Support is provided 24x7 for Priority 1 incidents and during business hours (09:00-18:00 IST) for lower priorities. Response time targets: P1 30 minutes, P2 2 hours, P3 1 business day.

Relevant experience: three omnichannel contact-centre implementations for retail and telecom clients in the last four years.

References: Northwind Telecom (Head of Customer Operations) and Harbourline Retail (CIO). Contact details are provided in Annex C.